Common UI concepts

- Can't give everything yet
    - We only have a little HTML/CSS so far
- This is a start

Affordance

A hint that an interaction is possible

- Can be explicit
    - ex: a label
- Can be implicit
    - ex: a suggestive shape
- May only be triggered by a lead in action
    - ex: hover

Designers and Affordance

Designers LOVE to say something "affords" something

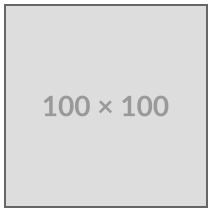
- Easy to lose track of what is being said
    - Jargon is not inherently good or bad
    - Designers definitely use *words*
    - I sometimes fail to connect them into ideas
- Affordance is an important concept
    - How do users know how to use your UI?

Placeholder images

- Lorem Ipsum is placeholder text
- Designs often have placeholder images
- Not intended for users
- Great during development
    - Can place and size without waiting

Placeholder Services

- Designers may provide placeholders
- Often, Devs have their own saved images
- Can use a placeholder service
    - **https://placehold.co**



    - **https://placecats.com**



Options

- Services can set the size of the desired image
    - **https://placehold.co/100**
        - **https://placehold.co/100x50**
    - **https://placecats.com/100**
        - **https://placecats.com/100/50**
- Other options may exist per service
    - Colors
    - Text
    - Distinctions between repeat sizes

Call to Action

- Trying to get the user to take an action
    - May be page concept or screen concept
    - Usually a button, link, perhaps a small form
        - With "punchy" text/colors

Ex: **"Find out more"**, **"Compare Prices"**, **"Register for free trial"**, **Download Now**

- Often "CTA" in designer text
- Don't want conflict between CTAs!
    - Ideally only one/screen
    - Max one/section

CTA Examples

- "Sign Up" on **https://www.ratemyprofessors.com/**
- NOT buttons on **https://www.catster.com/**
    - All same, no CTA
- **https://www.elgato.com/**
- **https://www.masterlock.com/**
    - Notice potential conflict

"The Fold"

- The "Fold" is the natural divide of web page:
    - What you can see without scrolling
        - "Above the fold"
    - What you have to scroll to see
        - "Below the fold"
- Originally a newspaper term
    - Still relevant
- Not 100% consistent
    - resolutions, widescreen, mobile

Predicting the Fold

- Rough desktop guideline:
    - 1000px wide, 600px high
    - That's *rough*
- No idea about mobile yet
    - So many options
    - But I see it done poorly often

Why do we care about the Fold?

- People may not want to scroll
    - If above the fold is boring, why bother?
- People may not know to scroll (desktop)
    - Don't hide scrollability
    - Scroll Affordance?
- Wasting time (particularly mobile)
    - Why give me content if I just have to scroll?
    - Poor UX bleeds into user opinions

Using the Fold

- Should have convincing material
- Should have a clear call to action
- Should make it clear when scrolling is possible
- Common to divide scrollable area into sections
    - Each with some call to action
    - Sections in order of priority

Hero Image

- The initial primary image for user focus
    - Often large to ensure it gets noticed
    - Sets the tone of the site
        - First impressions happen FAST

Hero Image considerations

- Common, but not required
- Too big = slow
- Too small = low value
- Tone mismatch = low value
- Too harsh = discourage visitors
- Responsive size

Panel

"Panel" - generic term for a box area with contents

- Often but not exclusively an image + text
- Often but not always horizontal alignment
- Creates blocks of tileable interface
    - Visual separation by **Contrast**/**Whitespace**
    - Important to maintain **Balance**
    - Easy to manage responsive/adaptive

Cards

- UI of content presented on a distinct panel
- Allows funneling of users to content
- Contents usually vertically aligned

Cards are single topic

- Contains content/actions regarding a single topic
- Easily "scannable"

Parts of card

Each part is optional

- Media (img, video, audio)
    - Don't autoplay
    - Aim for relevance
- Heading
    - Make sure to match heading structure
- Text
    - Keep it short and scannable
- Actions
    - Fewer is better
    - Make action clear

Deceptive Patterns - UI skills used AGAINST user

- **"Privacy Zuckering"**
  - Share more than intended
- **Bait-and-switch**
  - Tempting offer no longer available
- **Confirmshaming**
  - Drive users to act against their interests
- **Misdirection**
  - Hide/confuse/disguise flow
- **Roach Motel**
  - Hard to exit/cancel/discontinue

More about Deceptive Patterns

- Many variations
    - **https://www.deceptive.design/types**
- Some are illegal in places!
    - Ex: California, Colorado, Virginia
    - **https://cyberlaw.stanford.edu/blog/2020/10/dark-patterns-and-ccpa**
    - **https://www.bytebacklaw.com/2022/03/how-do-the-cpra-cpa-and-vcdpa-treat-dark-patterns/**
- **https://www.oecd-ilibrary.org/science-and-technology/dark-commercial-patterns_44f5e846-en**

Summary - Call to Action

- Usually a button/link
    - Stands out visual
    - Text asks for action
- Wanted above the fold
- Want one CTA per screen

Summary - The Fold

- Initial visible page
- Should be enough to keep user
- Often has Hero Image
- Should have CTA

Summary - Hero Image

- Big initial first impression
- Sets tone of page

Summary - Panels

- Distinct Rectangle/Oval tile
- Easy to use responsive/adaptive
- Basic Building Block of site
- Often horizontal content

Summary - Cards

- Specialized Panel
- Single-topic per card
- Easily scannable
- Funnels to actions
- Often vertical content

Summary - Deceptive Patterns

"Putting shareholder benefit ahead of user benefit"

- Using UI to trick or annoy user